

In-House Salary Guide

UAE, 2026 edition

Monthly base salary in AED, excluding bonus and allowances.

Legal

LEVEL	STANDARD	STRONG	EXCEPTIONAL
Chief Legal Officer	95k–128k	118k–159k	152k–204k
General Counsel	88k–119k	107k–145k	131k–177k
Head of Legal / sole counsel	60k–78k	72k–92k	85k–110k
Senior Counsel / Deputy GC	54k–72k	66k–89k	78k–105k
Legal Counsel	35k–48k	43k–58k	51k–68k
Junior Legal Counsel	25k–34k	30k–41k	37k–50k

Compliance

LEVEL	STANDARD	STRONG	EXCEPTIONAL
Head of Compliance / CCO	82k–110k	102k–137k	124k–167k
Director / MLRO	63k–85k	80k–107k	94k–127k
Senior Manager / VP	46k–63k	58k–79k	69k–93k
Compliance Manager	30k–40k	42k–56k	49k–66k
Senior Compliance Officer	22k–30k	27k–36k	32k–43k

The rest of the package

HOUSING

Often 20 to 30 per cent of base, or a fixed allowance; sometimes rolled into an all-in figure.

TRANSPORT

Around AED 2,000 to 3,500 a month, or a car at senior level.

FLIGHTS AND MEDICAL

Annual home flights and family medical cover are standard.

BONUS

Typically 10 to 25 per cent of base, higher at GC and CLO level and in financial services.

Sector matters as much as level. Sovereign, government-related and financial services employers tend to pay 10 to 25 per cent more than the rest at senior level.